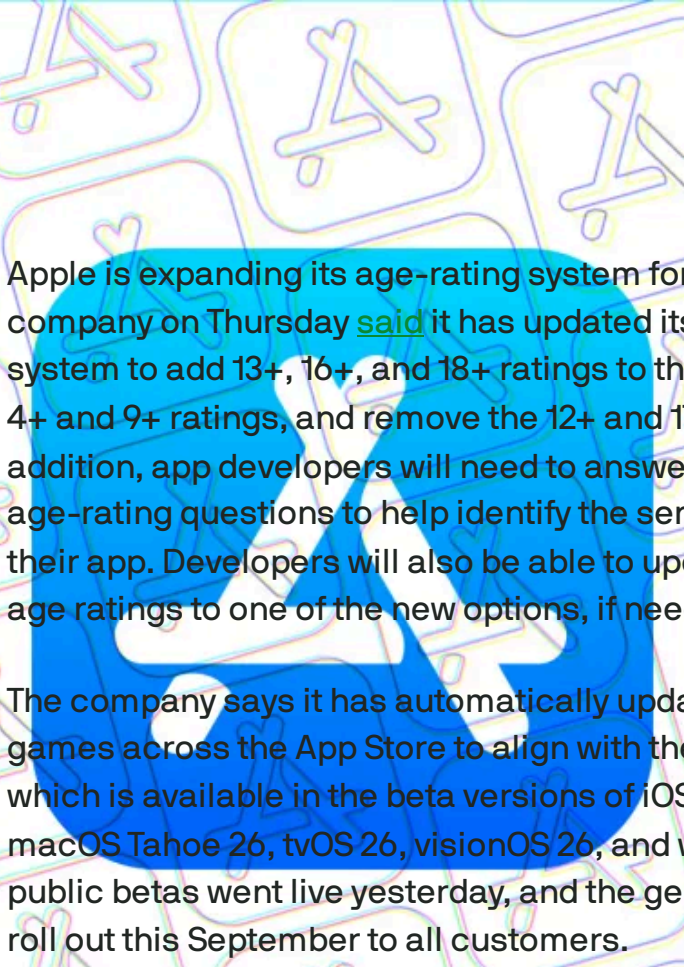




APPS



Apple broadens App Store's age-rating system



Apple is expanding its age-rating system for apps. The company on Thursday [said](#) it has updated its age-rating system to add 13+, 16+, and 18+ ratings to the existing slate of 4+ and 9+ ratings, and remove the 12+ and 17+ age ranges. In addition, app developers will need to answer a new set of age-rating questions to help identify the sensitive content in their app. Developers will also be able to update their apps' age ratings to one of the new options, if needed.

The company says it has automatically updated all apps and games across the App Store to align with the new system, which is available in the beta versions of iOS 26, iPadOS 26, macOS Tahoe 26, tvOS 26, visionOS 26, and watchOS 26. The public betas went live yesterday, and the general release will roll out this September to all customers.

As part of the updated system, developers will need to inform Apple about their in-app controls and app capabilities, [answer questions about medical and wellness topics](#), and [disclose whether their app or game contains violent themes](#). Apple will then calculate the appropriate age rating, which developers can view and modify in App Store Connect.

The ratings are intended to offer parents more specific guidance about the apps their kids want to download, and will prevent kids from installing apps that exceed their age range. On Apple's side, the App Store also won't feature certain apps in areas like the editorial stories, Today, Games, and Apps tabs if they're not age-appropriate for the child using the device.

The expanded age ranges are part of a broader update around [child safety initiatives announced earlier this year](#). For parents, Apple is making it easier to set up child accounts and share information about their kids' ages. This data will be shared with app developers to help provide age-appropriate content. (Some of the changes for child accounts were first made available in the public beta of 18.4, out earlier this year.)

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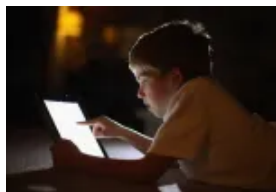
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Apple introduces new child safety initiatives, including an age-checking system for apps



Apple on Thursday announced a range of new initiatives designed to help parents and developers create a safer experience for kids and teens using Apple devices. In addition to easier setup of child accounts, parents will now be able to share information about their kids' ages, which can then be accessed by app

developers to ... [Continue reading](#)

App Store product listings will also be updated to include more information to help guide guardians' decisions about whether or not an app or game is right for their child or teen. For instance, guardians will be informed if the app features user-generated content or ads, both of which could expose younger children to adult content. Plus, they'll be informed if an app offers built-in parental controls.

Increasing an app's age rating could reduce its visibility and distribution, which could encourage app developers to introduce parental controls or other age-appropriate experiences.

TC

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The changes to the App Store arrive as legislative disputes grow at both the state and [federal](#) levels about how children should be protected online, with U.S. states introducing [new bills and laws](#) that would require app store operators to check kids' ages to get parental consent for downloading apps.

Apple and Google would prefer that the app makers themselves handle the age-verification process, but larger tech companies like Meta [have lobbied](#) for app stores to do the verification.

Apple’s solution is a system that will protect the child’s personal information, like their birth date, by offering a developer API that gives them access to the age range information they need to customize their app experience appropriately. Because this information would be provided by the parent during the set-up of a new device, it’s more likely to be accurate than if kids entered their birthday or age into an app directly, as kids may lie about their age to access an app’s full experience.

However, for this to work, developers will have to opt to integrate with the new API.

Topics: [app store](#) [Apple](#) [Apps](#) [Apps](#)

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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [🦋](#) [@](#) [in](#)

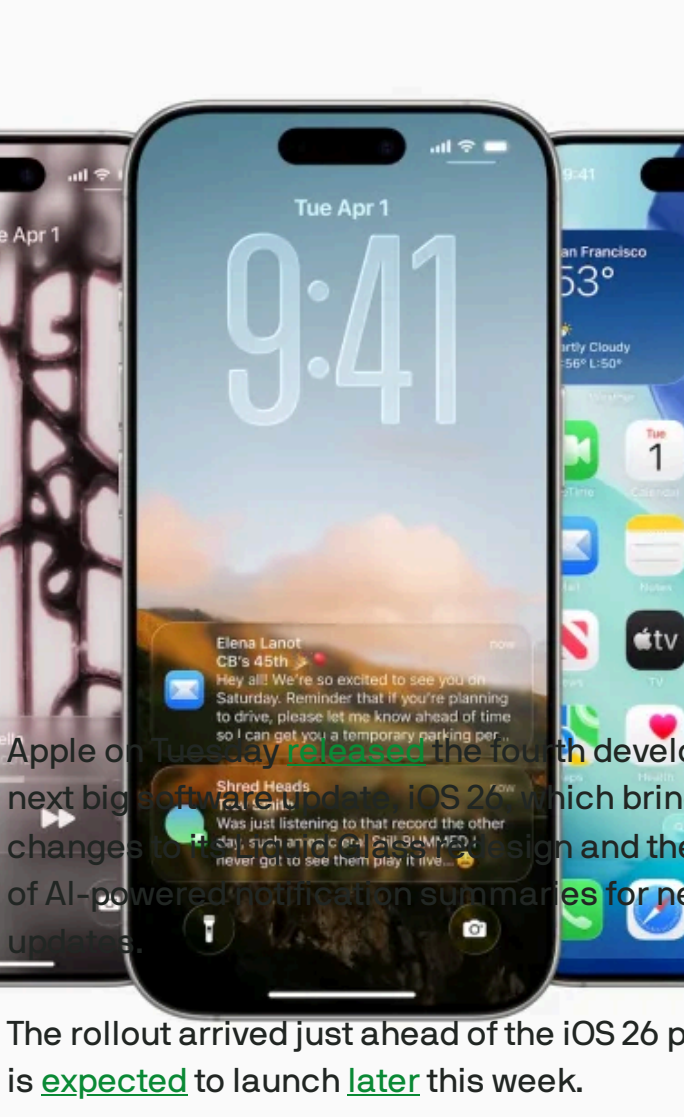
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iOS 26 beta 4 arrives, with Liquid Glass tweaks and AI news summaries

Sarah Perez — 11:47 AM PDT · July 22, 2025

Apple on Tuesday released the fourth developer beta of its next big software update, iOS 26, which brings with it slight changes to its Liquid Glass design and the re-introduction of AI-powered notification summaries for news, among other updates.

The rollout arrived just ahead of the iOS 26 public beta, which is [expected](#) to launch [later](#) this week.

IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

The developer betas are meant to give mobile app makers time to test their apps with Apple's new software so they're ready for the public launch of the new operating system in the next few months. Because of consumer demand for early releases, Apple [for years](#) has been offering public betas following its Worldwide Developers Conference in June. This allows iPhone owners to also get their hands on the updated software before its wider, global launch, but with fewer stability issues and bugs.

The latest developer beta (iOS 26 beta 4) largely reflects what users can expect in the coming public beta.

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Thompson, had died by suicide, which wasn't true. As a result, [Apple said a software update](#) would be released to clarify when the text shows an AI summarization.

The setup screen for this AI summarization feature, still in beta, includes a warning message under the “News & Entertainment” section. Here, Apple notes that “Summarization may change the meaning of the original headlines” and advises users to “Verify information.”

Other early adopters of the new beta also found that Apple is continuing to refine its user interface redesign known as Liquid Glass.

While [beta 3 pulled back](#) on some of the more transparent elements in some apps, beta 4 reverses things again. Testers have pointed to updates in apps like the [App Store](#), [Photos](#), [Apple Music](#), [Weather](#), and elsewhere, and noted that the Notification Center [also adds a dynamic tint](#) as you scroll.

iOS 26 Beta 3 vs iOS 26 Beta 4

Which version of Liquid Glass looks better?

pic.twitter.com/iFC8FiXE2P

— Brandon Butch (@BrandonButch) [July 22, 2025](#)

iOS 26 Beta 4 adds a dynamic tint to the Notification Center as you scroll through notifications! pic.twitter.com/18AU8t4SHH

— Brandon Butch (@BrandonButch) [July 22, 2025](#)

iOS 26 Beta 4 brings a more visually comfortable change when viewing notifications.

Now, the wallpaper gets darker right when we enter the notification centre. pic.twitter.com/UaP1FW7RvQ

— Alvin (@sondesix) [July 22, 2025](#)

In iOS 26 beta 4, if you are reading a notification, your background will gradually get darker to make it more



readable pic.twitter.com/rphblbWIWR

— Aaron (@aaronp613) [July 22, 2025](#)

The updated software [additionally](#) includes a new dynamic wallpaper, which changes colors, and [new CarPlay wallpapers](#).

iOS 26 Beta 4 brings new dynamic wallpaper

pic.twitter.com/sCo1lmB8H5

— Aaron Zollo (@zollotech) [July 22, 2025](#)

Release notes for beta 4 had not been published on Apple's Developer website at the time of publication, so there is likely more to be spotted, especially in terms of minor bug fixes and performance improvements.

Alongside today's release, Apple also launched new versions of its other betas, including iPadOS 26 beta 4, macOS 26 beta 4, watchOS 26 beta 4, tvOS 26 beta 4, visionOS 26 beta 4, and Xcode 26 beta 4.

Topics: [AI](#) [Apple](#) [Apps](#) [iOS](#) [iPadOS](#)



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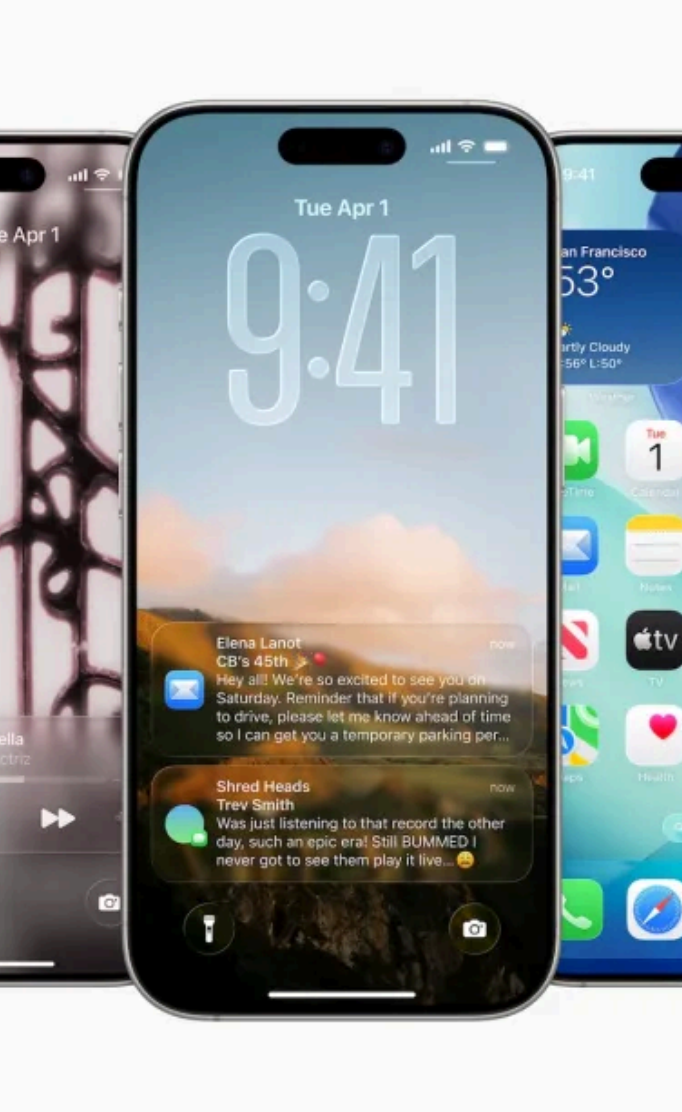


IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

HARDWARE



WWDC 2025: Everything announced, including Liquid Glass, Apple Intelligence updates, and more

Lauren Forristal, Sarah Perez

12:21 PM PDT · June 9, 2025

WWDC 2025 kicked off Monday and as in previous years, the company focused on software updates and new technologies, including the next version of iOS, [called iOS 26](#).

This year, there was considerable pressure on the company to build on its promises and to [make amends to developers](#) as it lags behind in AI and faces continued legal challenges over its App Store.

iOS 26 is the most dramatic design change in over a decade

When Apple introduced a major overhaul to iOS back in 2013 with the launch of [iOS 7](#), it felt jarring for many users with the shift from the prior skeuomorphic design with gradients and real-world textures to the more colorful, but flat, design style



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Rebecca Szkutak - 2 days ago

that reflected Apple's then chief design officer Jony Ive's taste for minimalism.

At WWDC 2025, the company announced a [refreshed user interface called Liquid Glass](#), which features shiny, reflective, and transparent visual interface elements that give the software a more "glassy" look and feel.

The Liquid Glass display is translucent and will behave like glass in the real world. The color of the screen is informed by your content and will adapt between light and dark environments. In addition, alerts appear from where you tap, context menus expand into a scannable list when you scroll and tap.

The Lock Screen and Home Screen are [getting updates](#) that align with the overall aesthetic of Liquid Glass.

iOS 26, a new naming scheme

Instead of using system names like iOS 19 and macOS 19, [Apple will now use the year as part of the name](#). This means all its operating systems will be called iOS 26, iPadOS 26, macOS 26, tvOS 26, watchOS 26, and visionOS 26.

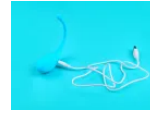
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Nintendo raising original Switch console prices due to 'market conditions'

Aisha Malik - Aug 1, 2025

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Sex toy maker Lovense threatens legal action after fixing security flaws that exposed users' data

Zack Whittaker - Aug 1, 2025



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A dedicated Games app

Apple unveiled a new [dedicated gaming app](#) that is designed to centralize gaming experiences on Apple devices. The app

will serve as a launcher for games and allow users to track achievements and view leaderboards.

The Games app will also include social features, including a “Play Together” tab that lets you see what your friends are playing, compare scores, and invite them to play with you. There’s also “Challenges,” which is a new way to compete with friends in score-based showdowns.



IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

MacOS, iPadOS, watchOS, visionOS, and tvOS updates

Apple showed off [watchOS 26](#), the upcoming software overhaul for the Apple Watch. It will launch with a redesigned interface based on Apple’s new Liquid Glass operating system, a wrist-flick gesture, a new Apple Intelligence-powered [Workout Buddy fitness feature](#), and more.

Apple TV is [also getting a redesign](#), featuring a Liquid Glass aesthetic that offers a sleek and “unobtrusive” design, the company said. One of the standout features is the ability to quickly jump into a user profile. Apple TV will now present profile options each time it wakes from sleep, making it more convenient for each family member to select their profile and quickly resume watching their own favorite shows and movies. There’s also a [karaoke feature](#).

macOS 26, [which the company calls Tahoe](#), is [getting some upgrades as well](#), in addition to the new Liquid Glass aesthetic will include an [AI-powered Shortcuts app](#).

iPad OS will make the [iPad feel like a Mac](#), including a new [Preview feature](#) that gives users a range of tools, including

markup using Apple Pencil and AutoFill. Users can also export images in different formats.

And along with [updates to visionOS](#), Apple’s Vision Pro AR/VR headset is getting [a couple of new accessories](#): a Logitech Muse stylus and PlayStation’s VR2 Sense controller compatibility.

Updates to CarPlay and AirPods, too

While leaks suggested more gestures and other additions, Apple announced that the [AirPods lineup would be getting two key features](#): studio-quality audio recording and camera remote. It’s also getting a camera remote.

Three of the [biggest additions to CarPlay](#) will be widgets and live activities, as well as the ability to choose a “tapback” response to incoming messages. Users will now also be able to pin their favorite conversations, just like in iMessage.

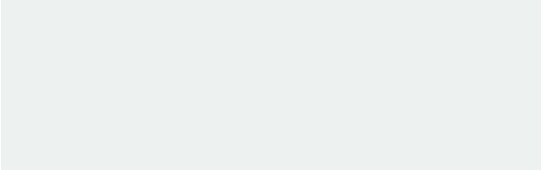
Apple Wallet, polls, Maps, and more

Other smaller features were announced as well, like new [travel-friendly features for Apple Wallet](#); [polls in iMessages](#); [lyrics translation and pronunciation features](#); and Maps will [learn your commute](#).

This story was originally published on June 5 and was updated significantly with all the announcements from WWDC 2025 on June 9.

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Lauren Forristal
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Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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